



Prof. Dr. Mee SONU (Saitama University, Japan)

Biography: I am Mee SONU, Director of the Center for Japanese Language Education at Saitama University. My current research explores Japanese speech learning for students from diverse linguistic backgrounds, such as Burmese, Syrian, Chinese, and Korean. I strive to identify unique phonetic acquisition patterns to create more accessible learning methodologies. In addition to my work in phonetics, I collaborate on projects involving AI in language education and the sociology of multicultural coexistence, aiming to support a more inclusive society.

Perceptual Characteristics of Japanese Length Contrasts at Various Speaking Rate by Burmese Native Listeners

Abstract: A 2024 Japan Foundation (JF) survey reveals that Myanmar has climbed to 9th place in the number of Japanese language learners, marking a 424.6% increase. Despite this rapid growth, research on their phonetic acquisition is still limited. This study aims to clarify the perceptual features of Japanese vowel and consonant length contrasts among Burmese speakers, with a particular focus on the impact of speech rate variability. This study conducted a perception test incorporating various speech rates to identify the perceptual characteristics of native Burmese speakers. This presentation reports on these findings.



Date: 8 Mar 2026 (SUN),



Time: 10:00 to 11:30 (ICT, UTC+7)

12:00 to 13:30 (JST, UTC+9)

Webex Meeting Link: 



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